

SHASHANK REDDYHALLI RAKESH

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AI/ML Engineer, published researcher, and **0→1 founder** with **5+ yrs in tech**, turning **research into production ML**, leading communities **100,000+ strong**. **1st place & 6th worldwide**, SmashHack (NSF HDR).

EDUCATION

University of California San Diego	2025 – Present
Master of Science in Data Science	
Visvesvaraya Technological University	2021 – 2025
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Engineering	

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (3+ years)

UC San Diego — Student Assistant (Operations)	Mar 2026 – Present
• Automate manual workflows into internal tools that save staff hours, beyond core administrative support.	
Digitide — Data Scientist Intern	Feb 2025 – Jun 2025
• Powered business decisions by building end-to-end ML pipelines (EDA, features, NLP) over 100k+ records .	
• Reached a 0.98 F1 score in production by shipping tuned predictive & time-series forecasting models.	
UAS Dharwad — Product Manager, AgriTech	Mar 2025 – Aug 2025
• Owned product strategy & built a university-backed AgriTech marketplace for startups to onboard & sell.	
Blueed — Research & Development Intern	Jul 2024 – Nov 2024
• Powered product decisions for 2,000+ active users by building WaitKyu's data & analytics backbone .	
• Lifted UX by shipping ML-powered insights and rigorously tested, reliable features.	
Orbitor (Bharat Intern) — Data Science & ML Intern	Jan 2024 – Mar 2024
• Developed predictive ML models for survival analysis & classification, reaching ~92% accuracy.	
VOIS — AI/ML Intern Oct-Nov'23 EdVedha — Full Stack Web Developer Intern Nov'23-May'24	
IBM -Cyber Security Intern Oct-Nov'23 UniConverge Technologies-SDE Intern & Mentor May-Aug'23	

PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

AudioVeritas — Deepfake Audio Detection System	Sep 2024 – Jan 2025
• Engineered an SVM deepfake-audio detector on MFCC/spectral features, 95.7% accuracy.	
• Published and secured funding to advance the work in media forensics & cybersecurity.	
Colorectal Cancer Detection via Speech Biomarkers	Jan 2024 – Jul 2024
• Built a CNN for early colorectal cancer detection from vocal biomarkers (non-invasive, low-cost).	
Hierarchical Deep Learning for Robust Intrusion Detection	Oct 2023 – Feb 2024
• Designed a hybrid DL+ML intrusion-detection system with an adversarial-example detector .	
• Achieved accuracy gains under adversarial conditions with optimized use of compute.	
Security Issues and Defensive Approaches in Deep Learning Frameworks	Aug 2023 – Dec 2023
• Mapped attacks to defenses across deep-learning frameworks in a practical threat-model taxonomy.	
• Delivered a blueprint for trustworthy, secure AI in production deployments.	
Certifying Text Classifiers vs Levenshtein Attacks — Reproducing LipsLev (ICLR 2025)	Apr 2026 – Jun 2026

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (reaching 100,000+ globally)

TechForge - Founder & President, national hackathon partnerships across multiple universities	Oct 2023 – Jul 2025
FOSS United - Chapter Lead & Organizer, 20,000+ members , national conferences	Sep 2023 – Aug 2025
ParrotSec (HTB) - India Lead & Global Moderator, 50M+ downloads , 95.5K+ community	Mar 2020 – Jun 2025
Cybernity - Co-Founder of a 10,000+ member international cybersecurity community	May 2020 – May 2025

SKILLS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Tech: Python, SQL, R; Machine Learning, Deep Learning, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-learn, XGBoost, Pandas, NumPy; Generative AI, LLMs, RAG, Prompt Engineering, Hugging Face, LangChain, LoRA/PEFT, Vector DBs (FAISS); AWS, Docker, Git, CI/CD, MLflow, Model Deployment, PostgreSQL; NLP, EDA, Statistical Modeling, A/B Testing

Awards: **1st place & 6th globally**, [SmashHack ML Hackathon](#) (UC San Diego & NSF HDR); [Outstanding Achievement & Contribution Award](#) (JNNCE); [Runner-up, Hack for Hire](#) (Anvesana TBI)